3.0 BREAKING CHANGE

n8n 3.0: published workflows with a removed node don't activate

n8n's docs say their triggers stop firing. The release notes list 3.0 as released 2026-10-27, while the breaking-changes page calls it an early access release.

ENTER

ANY WORKFLOW		IF PUBLISHED
— USES REMOVED NODE	VS	• DOESN'T ACTIVATE
— FAILS WHEN IT RUNS		• TRIGGERS STOP FIRING

• EXHIBIT 02 · THE FAILURE MODE

Two outcomes n8n lists for a removed node

In n8n's words: workflows that use a removed node fail when they run. If such a workflow is published, it doesn't activate when n8n 3.0 starts, so its triggers stop firing.

01

CRON: SCHEDULE TRIGGER

02

INTERVAL: SCHEDULE TRIGGER

03

FUNCTION: CODE NODE

04

FUNCTION ITEM: CODE NODE

05

ITEM LISTS: REMOVED

06

READ PDF: REMOVED

EXHIBIT 03 · REMOVED NODES

Six nodes from n8n's removed list

Per n8n's page: replace Cron and Interval with the Schedule Trigger node, and Function and Function Item with the Code node. Item Lists and Read PDF are on the list too.

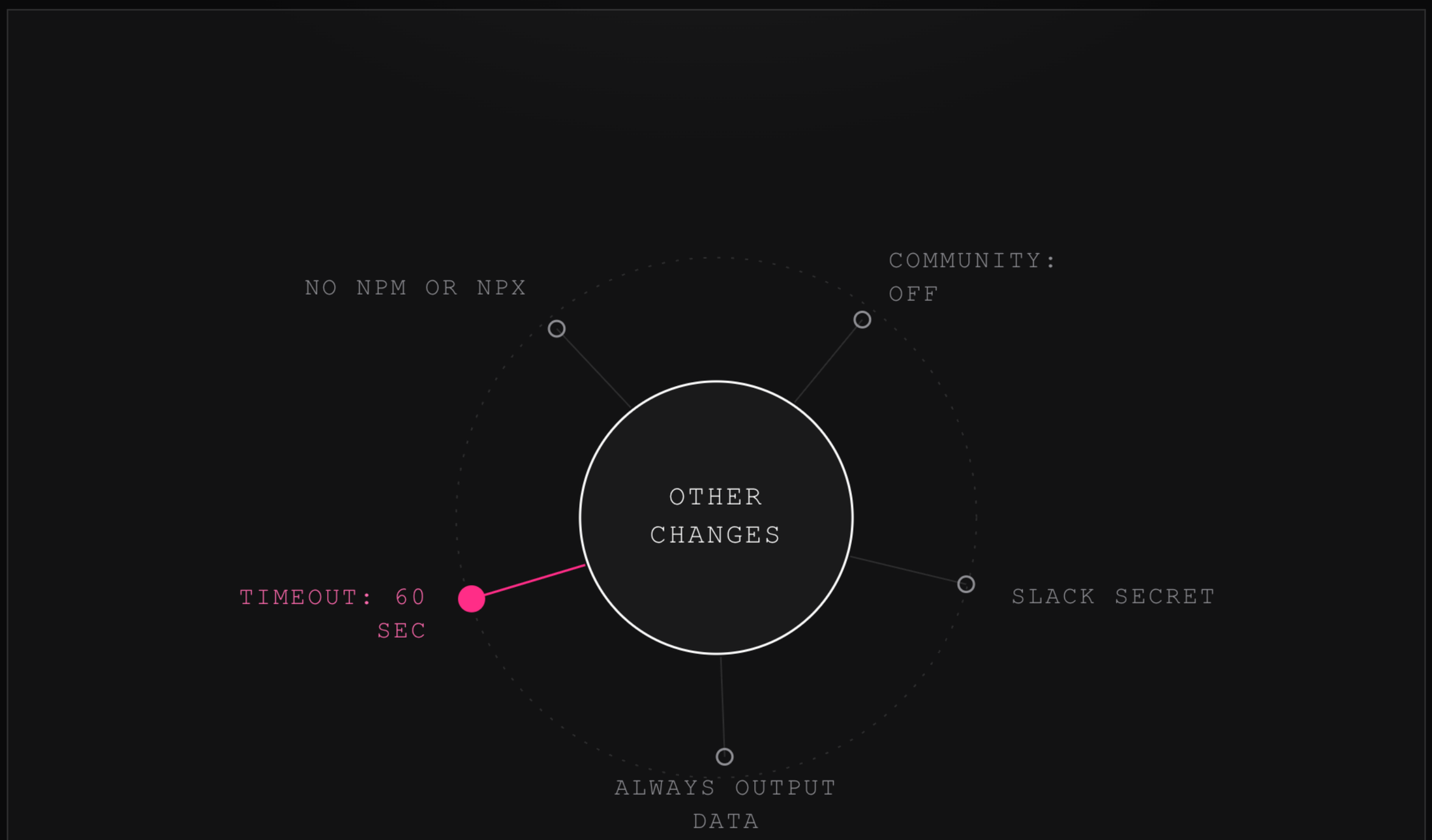


EXHIBIT 04 · QUIET CHANGES

Not every break is a removed node

Per n8n: the task runner timeout default drops from 300 to 60 seconds, npm and npx installs are unsupported, unverified community packages default to off, Slack needs a signing secret, and Always Output Data changes.

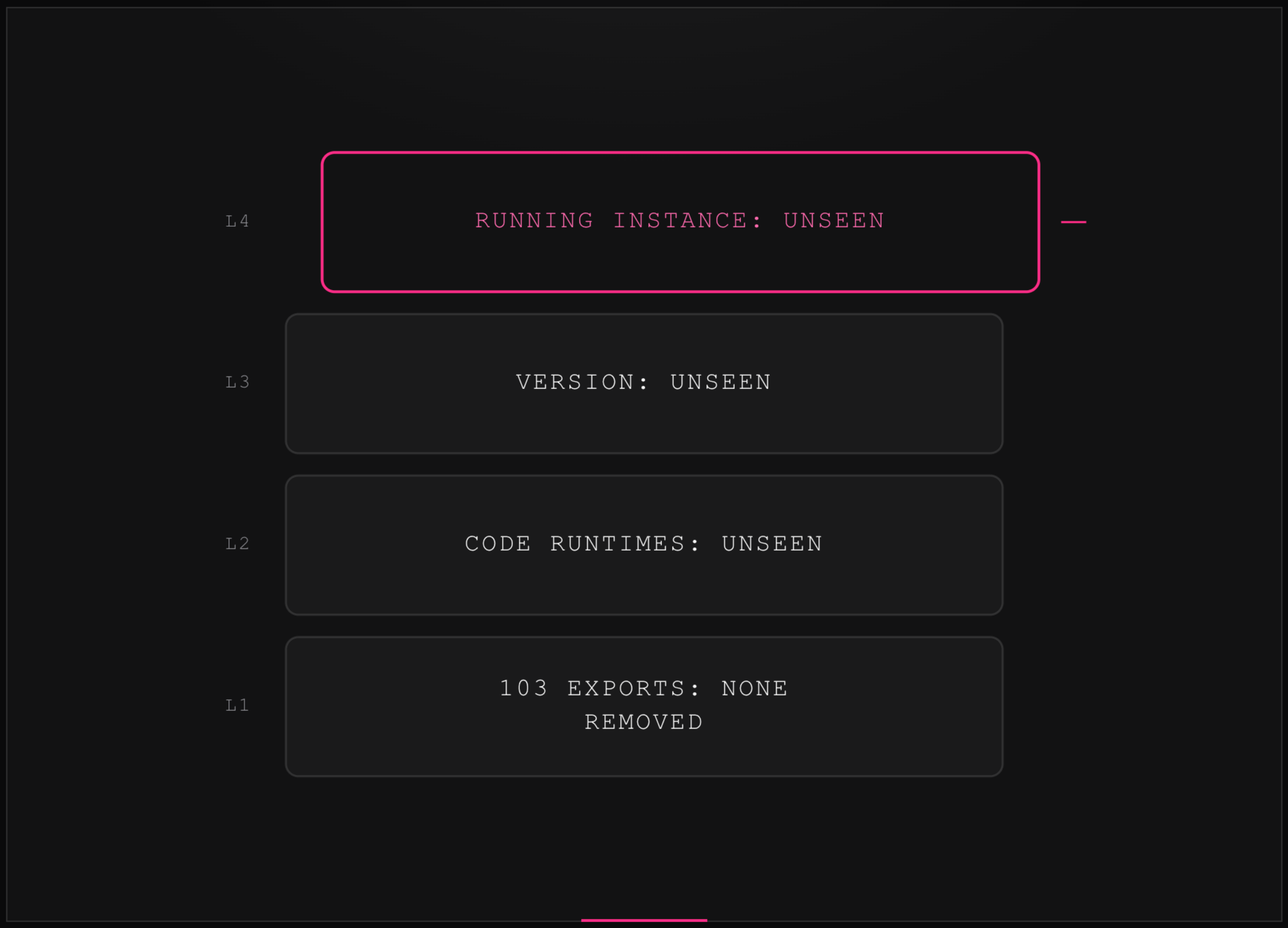


EXHIBIT 05 · THE HONEST LIMIT

The scan sees files. It can't see the instance.

103 unique workflow exports on my machine, none with a removed node. Zero in files says nothing about the running instance, its version, or whether a Code node runs past 60 seconds.

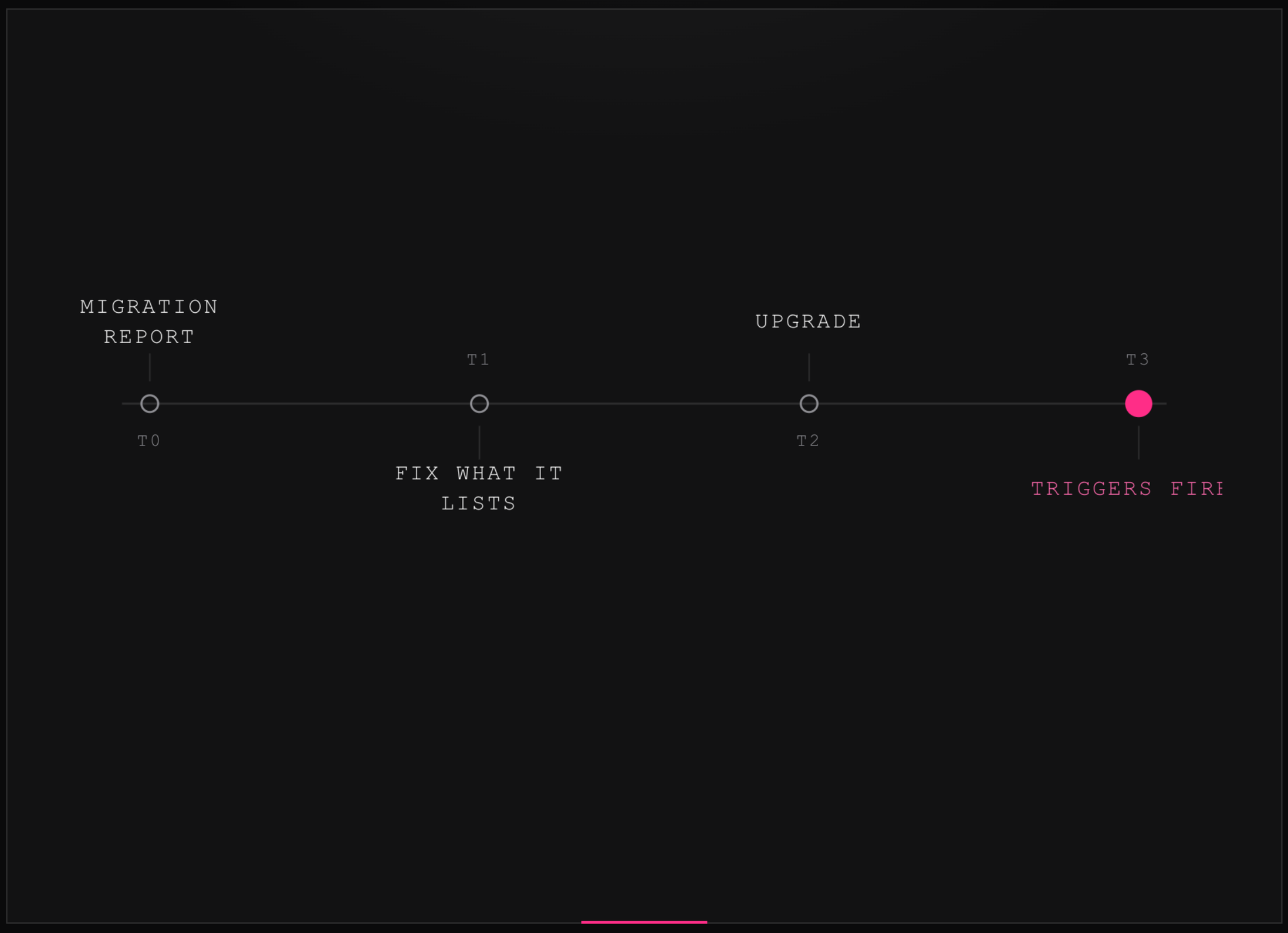


EXHIBIT 06 · ORDER OF OPERATIONS

Report, fix, upgrade, then check triggers fire

n8n says to run Settings > Migration Report before you upgrade. The last step is my addition: after the upgrade, confirm triggers actually fire, using execution history.



Run the report before you upgrade

Settings > Migration Report lists what needs attention on your own instance.

RUN THE REPORT